



National Technical
Assistance Center
on Transition



Who Does What? Optimizing Employment Services and Supports through Individual Planning for College Students with Intellectual Disability

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Think College National Coordinating Center is a project of University of Massachusetts Boston, Institute for Community Inclusion.
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Think College National Coordinating Center

Federally funded since 2010 to provide coordination, training & technical assistance to any college or university who wants to establish or improve postsecondary education opportunities for students with intellectual disability on their campus

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📖 WHAT'S HAPPENING IN YOUR STATE



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Purpose: Build state agency capacity to:

ALL students and youth with disabilities to experience increased:

- enrollment in postsecondary education
- credential attainment
- competitive integrated employment
- community engagement



- 1 Use data-driven decision making processes
- 2 Strengthen interagency partnerships
- 3 Provide quality professional development
- 4 TA to SEA, VR, and other services in implementing effective pre-employment transition services and secondary transition practices & predictors

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The National Technical Assistance Center on Transition: The Collaborative (NTACT:C) is a Technical Assistance Center co-funded by the U.S. Department of Education's Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP) and the Rehabilitation Services Administration (RSA).

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Webinar Goals

Overview of higher education options and outcomes

An overview of potential state/national agencies employment partners

Suggested team members for planning employment services

A list of questions to support individualized planning

A case study illustrating how this approach is working with one college student

Tools for practitioners to put this into action

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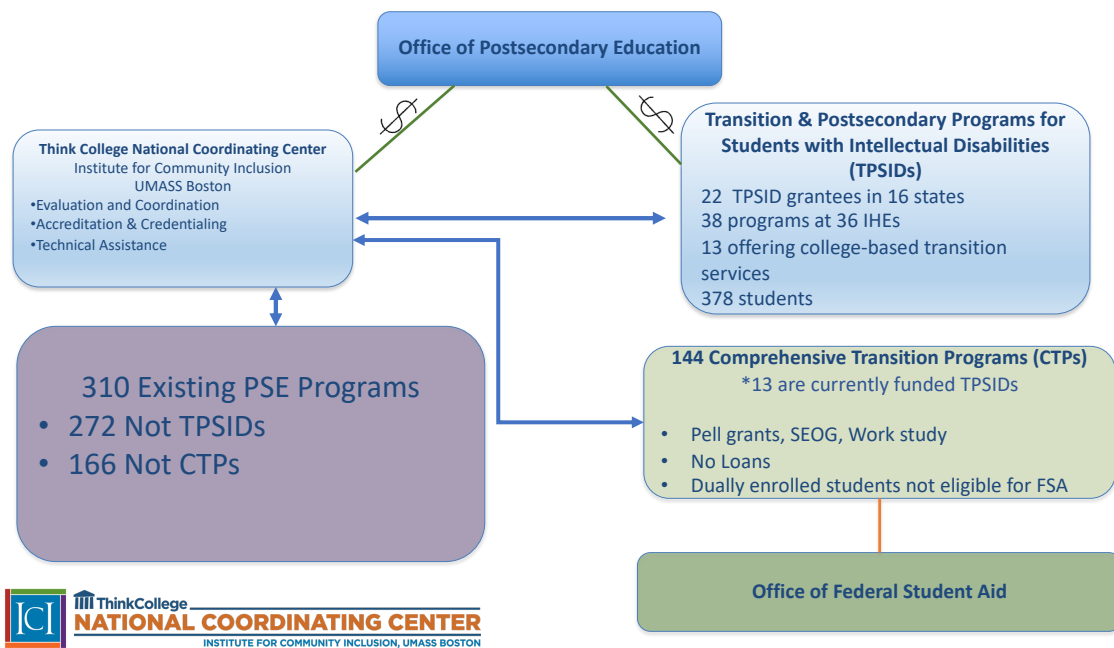
Higher Education Opportunity Act (HEOA)

- Enacted August 14, 2008
- Reauthorizes the Higher Education Act of 1965, as amended
- Model Demonstration Projects
- Coordinating Center
- Financial Aid access



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Higher Education Program Descriptions for Students with Intellectual Disability



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So just to be clear...

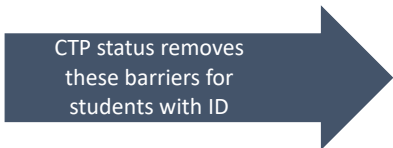
TPSID $\neq$ CTP

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What is a Comprehensive Transition Program (CTP)?

- Pathway to Title IV (i.e., federal) financial aid for students with intellectual disability
- Traditional requirements for accessing Title IV financial aid:
 - Required to be working toward a degree or certificate
 - Required to have a high school diploma, GED, or have passed an ability-to-benefit test

CTP status removes
these barriers for
students with ID



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Approved CTP Programs must:

- 1
Be offered by an IHE participating in Title IV
- 2
Be delivered to students physically attending the IHE
- 3
Be designed to support students with intellectual disabilities (ID) in preparation for gainful employment
- 4
Include an advising and curriculum structure
- 5
Require students with ID to interact with non-ID students
 - One-half of participation in academic components
 - Other opportunities for inclusive coursework and activities
 - Defined in 34 C.F.R. 668.231

So just to be clear

CTP approval ≠ Quality

CTP status signifies the program has met the regulatory requirements for approval from FSA

Programs approved CTPs can offer

*to eligible students

Federal Pell Grants

Federal Supplemental
Educational Opportunity Grants

Federal Work-Study funds



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The 3 Musts of FSA Eligibility

1

Student must have a
demonstrated
financial need

2

Student must be an
eligible student with
an ID

3

Student must be
enrolled in an
approved CTP
Program

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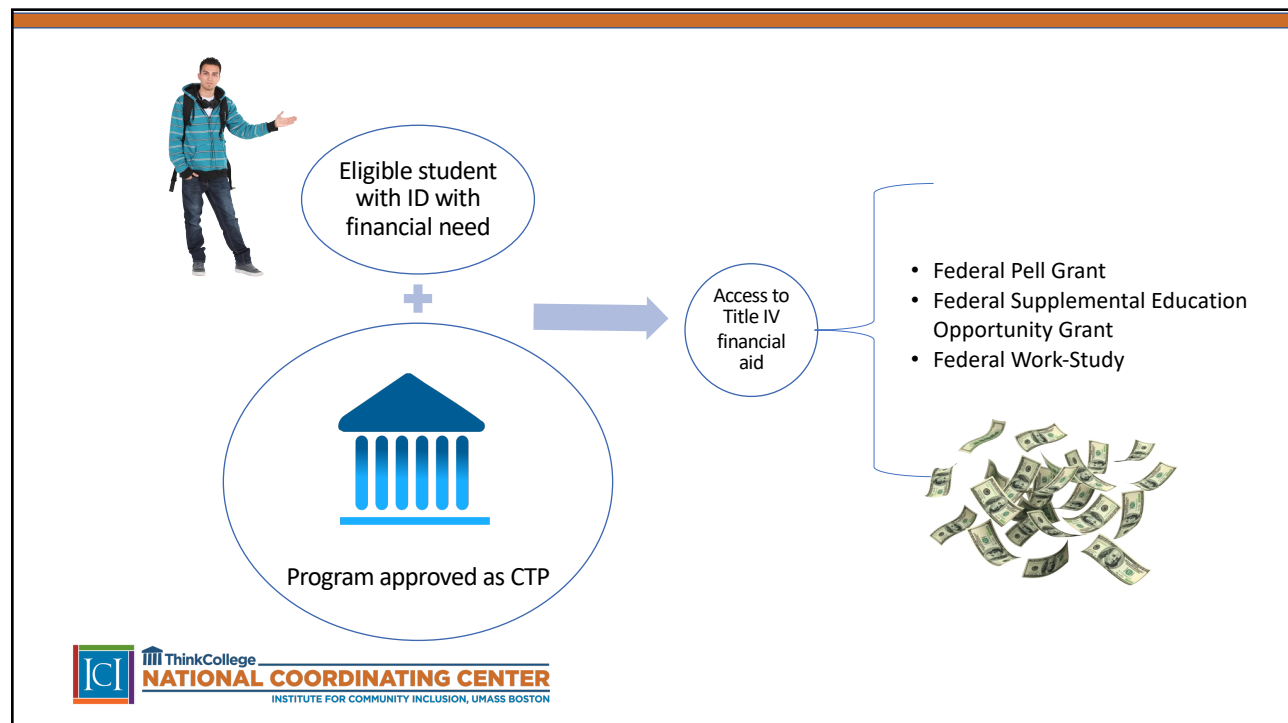
Important Changes to FSA Eligibility

Student does not
need a high school
diploma or a GED

Student does not
need to pass an
ability to benefit
test

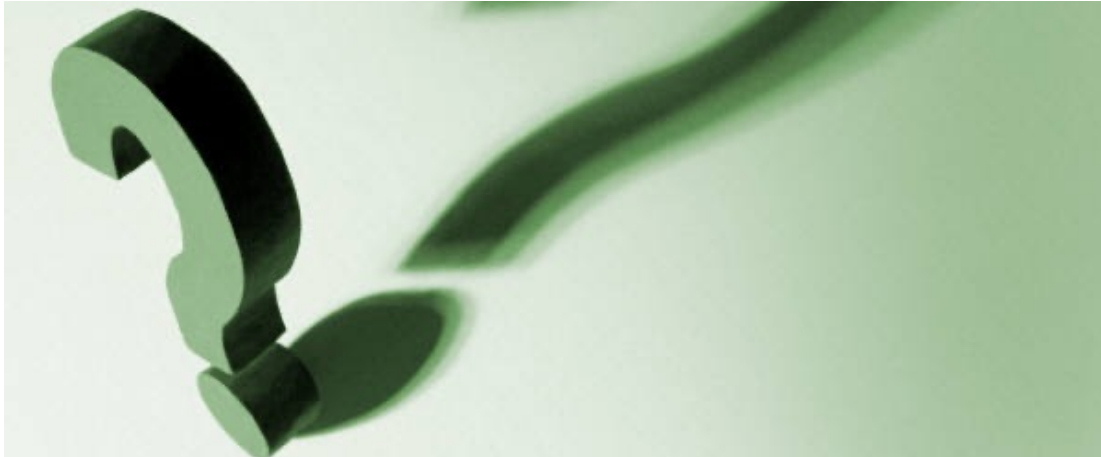
Student does not
need to be
matriculating
toward a degree

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What the heck is a TPSID?



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Transition Postsecondary Education Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities

- Grant funded model demonstration projects aimed at developing and expanding inclusive higher education options for people with intellectual disability.
- Funded by the Office of Postsecondary Education US DOE in 2010
- Receives technical assistance and evaluation from the TC NCC
- 3 funding cycles since 2010



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TPSIDs by the numbers

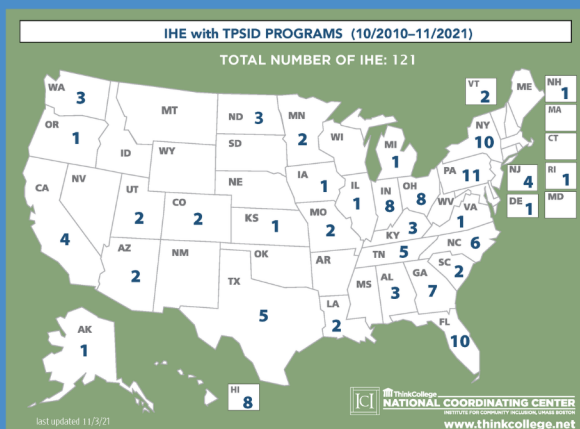
	Cohort 1 2010-2015	Cohort 2 2015-2020	Cohort 3 2020-2025
 Grantees	27	25	22
 States	23	19	16
 Programs	58	65	38*
 Students	2,167	2,122	378*

as of Oct 1 2021



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Since 2010 there have been



123 IHE with TPSID grants and associated sites in 34 states



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TPSIDs represent about 1/3 of higher education programs for students with ID in the US



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College-based transition services

AKA-dual enrollment, concurrent enrollment, 18-21 programs

Who

- High school students ages 18-22
- Typically students with ID/IDD
- Final 2-3 years of transition services

What

- Attend classes
- Work-based learning
- Campus activities
- Paid jobs

Where

- 114 programs nationally
- 13 program funded by TPSIDs
- Some are solely CBTS; other serve both HS students and adult students



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Agency Partners in TPSIDs

Partner type	Number of TPSID programs	Number of partnerships
Education agencies	19	36
Vocational Rehabilitation	18	20
University Centers for Excellence in Developmental Disabilities (UCEDDs)	15	15
State or county IDD agencies	13	13
Community rehabilitation providers	12	27
Developmental Disabilities (DD) councils	11	11
Employers	6	19
Advocacy groups	5	7
Other	6	8

TPSID programs partnered with 156 external organizations in 2020–2021

50% of programs partnered with LEAs

47% partnered with state VR agencies

Common partner roles:

- Advisory board (43%)
- Direct services (35%)
- Recruitment/outreach (33%)



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56% of employed students enrolled in the TPSID programs had never held a paid job prior to entering the TPSID.



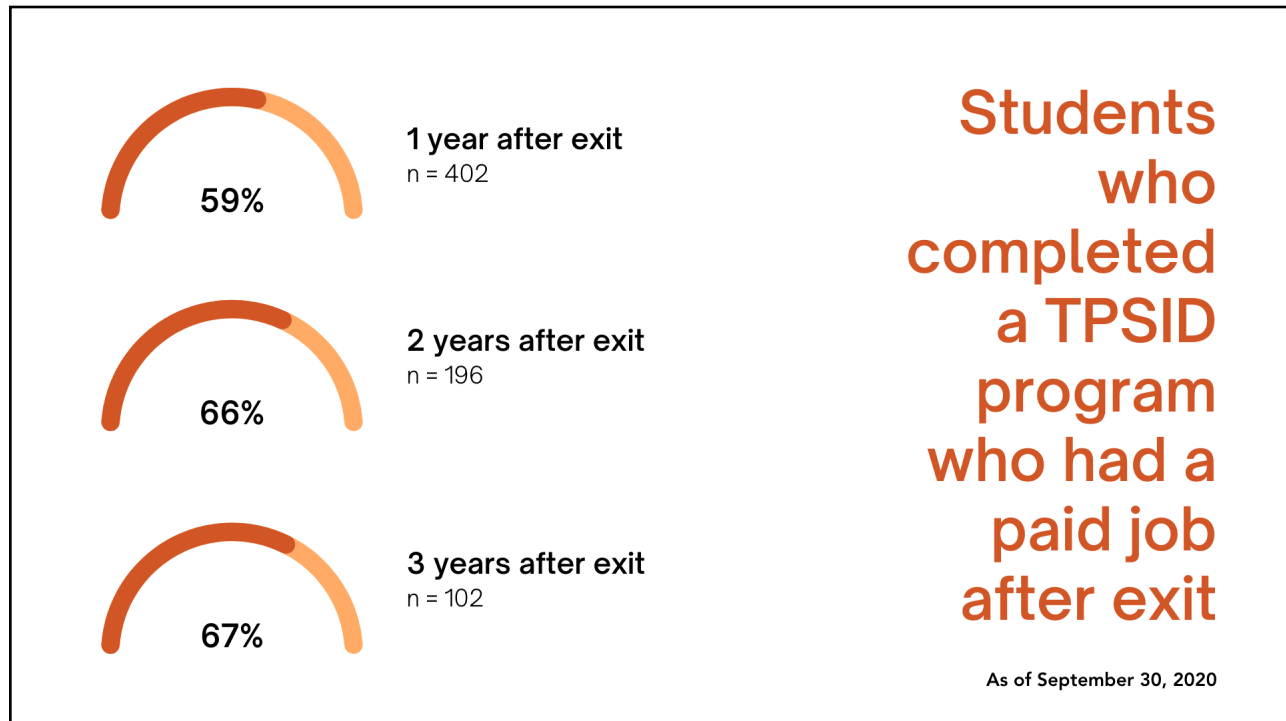
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Paid work
predicts
paid
work!!!

Students who obtained a paid job while enrolled were almost 15 times more likely to have a paid job at exit than those who did not.



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Potential Resources

Financial Support for Access to Inclusive College and University Programs

Program	Student
• State Agencies • State/Federal Grants • Students/Families • Grant funding • State budget/IHE • Alumni donors	• State Scholarships • Federal Financial Aid • Students/Families • Grant funding • State and Local Agencies • Local Community and Civic Organizations • ABLE Accounts

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Potential Partners & Resources

- **Secondary Education for those who are dually enrolled**
- **Developmental Disabilities**
 - **Medicaid Waiver Services**
- **Vocational Rehabilitation for VR-eligible students**

Other Important Partners:

- College and University Programs that enroll students with Intellectual Disabilities
- Community Rehabilitation Programs and Providers
- Other State and Local Agencies
- University Centers for Excellence in Developmental Disabilities (UCEDD)

[Increasing Postsecondary Opportunities and Success for Students and Youth with Disabilities](#)



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Understanding What Each Partner Can Do

- **Mission and Scope of Services**
 - Understanding each partner's roles/responsibilities
- **How the Agency/Organization Makes Services Available**
 - Understanding how each State implements and provides services
 - Availability and Eligibility
 - Policies and Procedures for Service Delivery
 - College Based Transition Programs
 - Postsecondary Education
 - Two and four year colleges and universities
 - Career (vocational and occupational) Training and technical education programs
 - Funding
 - Decisions as to which agency is responsible for providing and/or paying for services must be made at the State level.



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Participation in Postsecondary Education (Including Inclusive Programs)

“Nothing in the Rehabilitation Act prohibits or precludes VR agencies from supporting individuals with disabilities (including those with intellectual disabilities), who have been determined eligible for and are receiving VR services under an IPE, at comprehensive transition and postsecondary education programs in order to achieve their employment goal.” (Pg. 14)

“In sum, individuals with disabilities may be supported by

- VR agencies using VR funds to support “students with intellectual disabilities” as defined in Section 760(2)(B) of the HEA so long as it is necessary to achieve their employment goal, and by
- LEAs with funds under IDEA Part B, when the students have IEPs under IDEA and are dually enrolled in secondary and postsecondary education programs, including comprehensive transition and postsecondary programs. (p.14)”

Increasing Postsecondary Opportunities and Success for Students and Youth with Disabilities



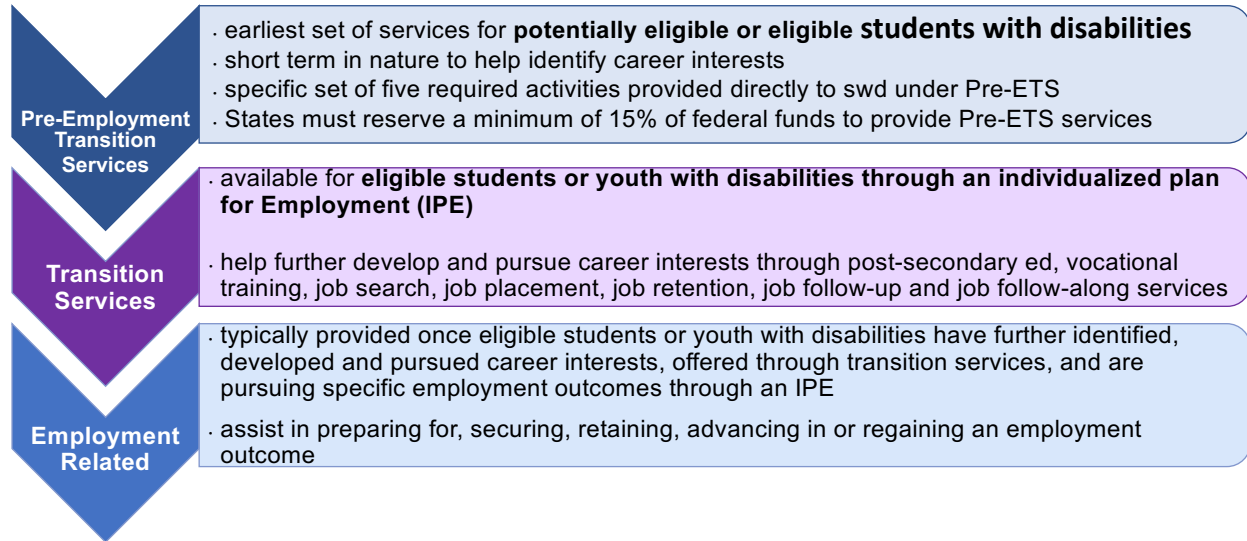
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Considerations Regarding the VR Program



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Continuum of Vocational Rehabilitation Services



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How VR Services are Provided or Arranged

- The State VR agency determines how services will be provided, as well as the mechanism they use to deliver the continuum of services. This may include services provided:
 - Directly by VR staff
 - Purchased Services
 - Services provided through a comparable benefit
- Some VR agencies may consider the separate components within the college and university program and what portion may fit within their service delivery system to provide pre-employment transition services (e.g. work based learning experiences).
- Other VR agencies may determine that enrollment in the college/university program is beyond the scope of pre-employment transition services, and may only be an allowable service in accordance with an approved IPE for VR eligible individuals when it is determined necessary for an individual to achieve their employment outcome.

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VR Transition Services for Eligible Students and Youth with Disabilities

Students and youth with disabilities who have been determined eligible for the VR program:

- Should work with their VR counselor to consider:
 - Consistent with individual's informed choice, the services and supports needed to achieve their employment goal on their IPE
 - The postsecondary environment that provides the educational program and supports necessary
 - Services included on the IPE, including those provided by other agencies as a comparable benefit
 - Whether or not the program will yield an industry recognized credential
 - How the program will assist the student in achieving outcomes consistent with the common performance measures (ie., sustained employment, median earnings, skill attainment (measurable skill gains and credential attainment)
- For VR agencies that consider financial need: Participation of individuals in cost of services based on financial need (34 C.F.R. § 361.54).



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Individualized Planning of Services for Students with Disabilities

“...The extent of the use of VR funds for these students will depend on whether they have been determined eligible for the VR program and have an approved IPE, or whether they need only pre-employment transition services.” (Pg. 14)

Pre-employment transition services are only available to those individuals with disabilities who meet the definition of a “student with a disability” in Section 7(37) of the Rehabilitation Act, meaning that the individual must be enrolled in an educational program and meet certain age requirements. (Pg. 12)

[Increasing Postsecondary Opportunities and Success for Students and Youth with Disabilities](#)



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Definition of a Student with a Disability (swd)

Individual with a disability who:

- Is in a secondary, postsecondary, or other **recognized education program**, and
- Falls within the requirements for minimum and maximum age (determined by each state), and
- Is either eligible for, and receiving, special education or related services under Part B of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, **OR** is a student with a disability for purposes of section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act

Pre-ETS may be provided to a **student with a disability (SWD)** who is either **eligible OR potentially eligible** for vocational rehabilitation services (i.e., all swd including those who have not applied or been determined eligible for vocational rehabilitation services), and need those services

- **Order of Selection (OOS) – Understanding how this may impact a student with a disability?**
- **If a swd is determined “ineligible”, how will that impact receipt of Pre-ETS services?**



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Pre-employment Transition Services	VR Transition Services
Designed to be an early start at job exploration for all students with disabilities who need them (includes eligible or potentially eligible students with disabilities).	Outcome-oriented services for eligible students and youth with disabilities in accordance with an approved IPE.
Provided or arranged by the VR agency based on individual's need, and should enrich transition planning, application to the VR program, and the continuum of VR services necessary for movement from school to postsecondary education or to an employment outcome.	Provides for further development and pursuit of career interests taking into account the student's or youth's preferences' and interests; and promotes or facilitates the transition from school to post-secondary life, such as achievement of an employment outcome in competitive, integrated employment.
Increases opportunities for students with disabilities to practice and improve workplace readiness skills, through work-based learning experiences in a competitive, integrated work setting.	Any allowable VR service can be provided as a transition service 34 C.F.R. § 361.48(b)(18)) under an IPE. These services include, but are not limited to, assessment, counseling and guidance, physical and mental restoration services, vocational and other training services, maintenance, transportation, job-related services including job search and placement assistance; job retention services, follow-up and follow along services
Increases opportunities for students with disabilities to explore post-secondary training options, leading to more industry recognized credentials, and meaningful post-secondary employment.	VR transition services that are within the nature, scope, and purpose of pre-employment transition services may be paid with the Pre-ETS reserve funds if needed by an eligible student with a disability to benefit from Pre-ETS.
May begin once a student requests or is recommended for one or more of the five required Pre-ETS, and is determined by VR to be a student with a disability in need of such services.	The specific transition services and supports needed may be provided once the student or youth has been determined eligible, and an employment goal or projected post-school employment outcome has been identified in accordance with an approved IPE. The IPE for a student with a disability must be coordinated with the IEP or 504 services, as applicable.
Pre-ETS must be provided or arranged in collaboration with location education agencies.	

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Considerations for Developmental Disabilities Agency

Eligibility requirements

- Type of Medicaid waiver
- Supports for personal supports v. employment supports

Working with VR

- Sequencing of Service (braided funding)
- Services that are stacked - who comes first

Leveraging Interagency Teams

In addition to Agency points of contact, many states have established interagency teams

These teams can be a great source of already established roles and responsibilities at the state and local levels using models like Circles

In addition, some states have implemented interagency teams at the individual level

Representatives to Invite to the Interagency Planning Meeting

Vocational Rehabilitation:

- Student's VR counselor
- Transition Coordinator
- Manager/Regional Director (decision-maker)

Developmental Disabilities:

- Student's direct case manager/counselor
- Manager of Supports/(Self-Directed) Waivers

College and University Programs:

- Director/Coordinator
- Employment Specialist/Career Development Manager/Job Developer

Student, Parents/Guardian, other Family Members

***Community Rehabilitation Provider/Community Employment Specialist-Job Coach** (when appropriate)

***Local Education Agency** (if student is dually enrolled in secondary and post-secondary programs)

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Questions to Consider

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Important Questions to Optimize Services and Supports

Individual's Status with each Agency

- Is the individual currently receiving services?
- What type of Services are they receiving?
 - **VR:** Are they a potentially eligible student with a disability who may receive only pre-employment transition services?; or
 - Are they a VR applicant and eligible individual who may receive additional VR services necessary to achieve an employment outcome in accordance with their approved IPE, including any pre-employment transition services they may need?;
 - **DD:** Type of Medicaid waiver
- If the individual is not currently receiving services:
 - Have they applied for services?
 - Is all necessary documentation in?
 - Has eligibility been determined?
 - Have they identified an employment outcome goal?
 - Is a plan in place that outlines the goals, roles, responsibilities, and services to be provided?

Availability of Services:

- What are the possible VR services available to this individual, based on their goal, need and eligibility?
- What are the possible DD services available to this individual, based on their need and eligibility?
- How could those services be coordinated with other available services and providers?

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Important Questions to Optimize Services and Supports

College and University Program:

- What are the individual's career interests?
- What does the program offer that aligns with those interests?
 - Curriculum
 - Course of Study
 - Internships and work based learning experiences
 - Credentials
- How does the program ensure it is in an integrated setting and maximizes programming with non disabled peers?
- What services are provided by the college and university program?
 - What is the breakdown of specific programming and services?
 - How are costs allocated per activity or service?

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Case Study: University of Maryland College Park **TerpsEXCEED**

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Meet Hari

My name is Hari Kannan, I'm 20 years old and I'm in a 2 year program called TerpsEXCEED. In this program I take classes and do activities like any other UMD students.

My interests are I like sports and my favorite teams are Green Bay Packers, Washington Capitals, UMD football and basketball teams and Washington Wizards. I love to listen to music and I have a passion on being fit and strong.

For my career and job search I'm trying to be a fitness and a wellness coach or a trainer. I have a huge passion in helping and training my friends and family to get through life and maintain a healthy lifestyle.



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Meet Hari

Dorm living: I live in a nice dorm and it's called Prince Frederick my friends said that it's amazing dorm. I love it and my room is small but I love the building and I have made friends in my building and we sometimes go and get dinner at the dining hall in south campus.

Classes: I take 4 classes this semester and they are Nutrition class, Personal and community health class, Internship and independent study. I love them it's interesting and it's why I want to become a trainer and a coach.

Activities: I love being a manager for Men's club soccer team, I'm helping Bringing Best Buddies back as a club. I go and workout at Eppley and Ritchie somedays.

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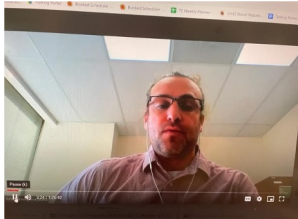
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Hari's Interagency Planning Meeting

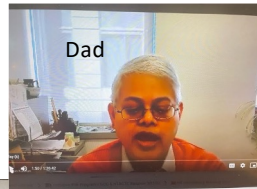
VR Counselor



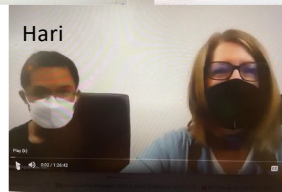
VR Transition Supervisor



Mom



Dad



Hari

IHE
Program
Director



DDA Case Mgr



IHE Career Specialist

DDA Regional Coordinator



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Important Questions to Optimize Services and Supports

Support for Individuals with Disabilities:

- How can DD, ED, Medicaid (waiver), VR, or others provide support for individuals with disabilities interested in participating in education programs at IHEs?
- One Potential Example:
 - ED – support if the student is dually enrolled and the program is consistent with goals on the IEP and are necessary to provide the student with FAPE
 - VR – support tuition costs, if the course of study is needed to achieve the IPE goal for the VR-eligible student.
 - DDA - program fees that are directly paying for individual supports
 - Medicaid Waiver Services



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Quotes from Hari's meeting

Hari's Dad: "We really want Hari to succeed in this program. We are very excited about this new collaboration with DORS & DDA coming together to offer him support and ways to succeed."

VR said "We are here to look at what kinds of supports and services that the students are eligible for and can be provided in a PSE setting"

IHE says: The question is: What's possible? We can provide the model, but you guys have the rules! Let's negotiate for what can happen - we all seem so open to it happening in a variety of ways.

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IHE says: "We want to figure out sustainability from all possible angles, and that's why we are taking this approach with interagency teams around each student. These programs are all over the country and they each look different in how they sustain. Let's look at individual student needs and eligibility and see how all these services can come together. It is complicated in that we could have 5 different students with 5 different plans! But that's the beauty of collaboration".

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We are the village!

- Partners are critical to effective planning
- Spend the time to learn about each other's roles and priorities
- Think and plan creatively for each student
- Collaboration leads to strong student outcomes

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Webinar Resources

We will send out an email to all attendees with a direct link to related resources, but just in case you don't like email....



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<https://thinkcollege.net/resource/webinar-resources-who-does-what-optimizing-employment-services-and-supports-through>

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What's in our News & Updates newsletter?

- The latest happenings at the National Coordinating Center
- Links to recent publications and upcoming events
- News from our partners: AUCD, AHEAD, and PACER's National Parent Center on Transition & Employment
- Federal and State legislative updates affecting postsecondary education
- News and information about postsecondary education from around the country



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